

Relapse Prevention Plan

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: A relapse prevention plan helps you identify personal risk factors, recognize warning signs early, and have a clear action plan ready. Complete this plan with your clinician and keep it accessible. Review and update it regularly.

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Emotional Triggers

Feelings or emotional states that increase risk (e.g., loneliness, anger, boredom, anxiety):

Environmental Triggers

Places, situations, or sensory cues that increase risk (e.g., certain locations, events, time of day):

Social Triggers

People, relationships, or social situations that increase risk (e.g., conflict, peer pressure, isolation):

My Warning Signs

Check the warning signs you have experienced before a relapse. Add your own.

Behavioral:

- Isolating from others
- Skipping therapy or meetings
- Neglecting responsibilities

Cognitive:

- Romanticizing past use / behaviors
- "Just once won't hurt" thinking
- Difficulty concentrating

- Returning to old routines / places
- Sleep pattern changes
- Other: _____

Emotional:

- Increased irritability or anger
- Hopelessness or despair
- Mood swings
- Overwhelming anxiety
- Emotional numbness
- Other: _____

- Denial that a problem exists
- Planning how to use / engage
- Other: _____

Physical:

- Fatigue or low energy
- Changes in appetite
- Physical tension or restlessness
- Neglecting personal hygiene
- Unexplained aches or pains
- Other: _____

My Coping Strategies

List healthy coping strategies for each trigger category.

For Emotional Triggers

What healthy ways can I manage difficult feelings?

For Environmental Triggers

How can I avoid or manage high-risk situations?

For Social Triggers

How can I handle social pressure and maintain healthy relationships?

My Support Network

People I can call when I need help. Include at least one person available 24/7.

#	Name	Phone Number	Relationship	Available When?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Emergency Action Plan

If I am at immediate risk of relapse, I will follow these steps in order:

Step 1: STOP what I am doing. Remove myself from the situation if possible.

Step 2: BREATHE. Use a grounding technique (5-4-3-2-1 senses, box breathing).

Step 3: CALL my support person: Name: _____ Phone: _____

Step 4: GO TO a safe place: _____

Step 5: USE a coping skill from my list above.

Step 6: If still at risk, CALL my therapist: _____

Step 7: If in crisis, CALL 988 or go to the nearest emergency room.

My Reasons for Recovery

Why is recovery important to me? What am I working toward?

CRISIS RESOURCES

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline — Call or text **988** (24/7)

Crisis Text Line — Text **HOME** to **741741** (24/7)

SAMHSA National Helpline — **1-800-662-4357** (24/7, free, confidential)

Emergency Services — Call **911**